



■ MENU

- [Home](#)
- [About](#)
  - [About Their Turn](#)
  - [About Animal Rights](#)
- [Issues](#)
  - [Food](#)
  - [Clothes](#)
  - [Entertainment](#)
  - [Experimentation](#)
  - [Companion Animals](#)
  - [Wildlife](#)
- [Contact](#)

October 6, 2026

## A Heartwarming Documentary about a Miracle Chicken

December 2, 2015 by [Donny Moss](#) — [Leave a Comment](#)

Share

Post



### The News

Move over, Esther the Wonder Pig! For a moment, the spotlight is shining on a chicken who is changing hearts and minds around the world. Her name is Penelope, and, against all odds, she survived a massacre.





Penelope, who almost died from Marek’s disease, is thriving today thanks to her rescuers

In the animal agriculture industry, chickens are typically stuffed into crates on the “farms” where they are fattened and shipped directly to slaughterhouses, where their short and painful lives come to a screeching halt. Not Penelope. She had the *added* misfortune of being sent on a treacherous detour – a detour that turned out to save her life.





Tens of thousands of chickens are held captive in crates with no food or water before being swung and slaughtered in a sacrificial religious ritual

Penelope, along with tens of thousands of other “broiler” chickens, was sold to ultra-Orthodox Jews in Brooklyn, New York, to be sacrificed in an annual religious ritual called Kaporos. During the ritual, participants grab the chickens by their fragile wings and swing them around their heads three times while saying a prayer to transfer their sins to the animal. After the ritual, a butcher in the street slaughters the chickens and dumps their dead – or still living – bodies into garbage bags.



Penelope’s rescuer wore a disguise to infiltrate the community where she would have sacrificed in a religious ritual

In his documentary short, filmmaker Duncan Skiles tells the magical story of how a brave woman, who stumbled upon the massacre, rescued a dying chicken, and, with the help of her compassionate husband, gave her a second chance.



## Penelope: A Rescue Story

Duncan Skiles



Watch on

Today, Penelope lives with her human flock in Brooklyn, just steps away from where she was saved. Like so many other rescued farm animals, Penelope has become an ambassador for all farm animals by showing people in the community that she is a unique and vibrant individual who wants to live.



After a short lifetime of deprivation and abuse, Penelope has learned how to trust humans

### Your Turn

Follow Penelope's journey at [Penelope the Chicken](#) on Facebook.

Please join the Facebook page [The Alliance to End Chickens as Kaporos](#) to lend your voice and support to the tens of thousands of chickens who are stuffed into crates, swung and slaughtered each year in the name of God.

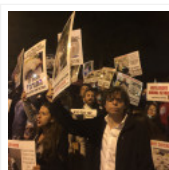
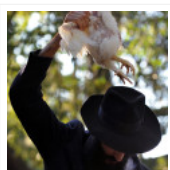




After a lifetime of abuse, neglect and deprivation, Penelope receives TLC from a (human) member of her flock

Filed under: [Food](#)  
Tagged with: [Alliance to End Chickens as Kaporos](#), [chickens](#), [Kaporos](#)

**You May Also Like:**

|                                                                                    |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |
| <a href="#">Lawyers File Emergency</a>                                             | <a href="#">VIDEO: Activists Disrupt Kaporos</a>                                    | <a href="#">Renewed Efforts to Stop Chicken-</a>                                    |

**Comments via Facebook**

**TheirTurn.net Comments**

- [insignia Brand wiki Want](#) says:  
[December 13, 2015 at 2:21 am](#)  
  
I am sure you are going to not find any 3D TV model that runs using 60 Hz. Lcd as well as plasma televisions Tv's have their own precise traits. Insignia tv This rejoinder or re-appearance of off-air high-definition antennas has led with a miraculous quality of HDTV broadcasts.  
  
HDTV antenna is one from the cheapest components of your HDTV system, however it leaves a huge impact about the HD signal reception. Foundation insignia of choice can be elected through the customers.
- Pingback: [WATCH: Meet Penelope, the Miracle Chicken | Ecorazzi](#)
- [Karen Davis, PhD](#) says:



[December 3, 2015 at 12:08 pm](#)

Thank you for this wonderful story about Penelope! She is giving and receiving the love that makes life worth living for all of us. May her joy continue and spread. Dear Penelope, dear hen, we love you.

Comments are closed.



## Follow Their Turn

- 

- 
- 
- 

## Subscribe to our newsletter

## Recent Comments

- [Are We Afraid of Our Own Compassion? - Hadar Aviram](#) on [Antisemitism in the Animal Rights Movement](#)
- Farm Animals for Animal Rights! on [TheirTurn Has Launched VegMediaWatch. Please Join Us There.](#)
- Teresa Russo on [TheirTurn Has Launched VegMediaWatch. Please Join Us There.](#)
- [Diplomi\\_nnEi](#) on [Despite Temporary Closures, Avian Flu Spreads in NYC's Live Animal Markets](#)
- CHRISTINE PHILLIPS on [New Watchdog Group Combats Anti-Vegan Bias in the Mainstream Media](#)







Food

TheirTurn Has Launched VegMediaWatch. Please Join Us There.

New Watchdog Group Combats Anti-Vegan Bias in the Mainstream Media

Despite Temporary Closures, Avian Flu Spreads in NYC’s Live Animal Markets

NYC Lawmaker Visits Notorious Live Animal Markets

Court Dismisses D.C. Restaurant Owner’s Lawsuit Against Anti-Foie Gras Activists

Clothes

Animal Rights Activists Protest Adidas Board Member Jackie Joyner-Kersey

Kangaroo Skin Protests Against Adidas Spread Globally

Anti-Kangaroo Leather Activists Disrupt Adidas Launch Party

NYPD Arrests Spouse of Marc Jacobs VP during Anti-Fur Protest

Activists in 20 Cities Protest Adidas Over Kangaroo Slaughter

Experimentation

After Pressure Campaign from Animal Rights Groups, HSUS Commits \$20 million to its Chimpanzee Sanctuary

HSUS’s Financial and Ethical Obligations to the Chimpanzees at Project Chimps and the New Iberia Research Center

Activists Erect Billboard in Georgia to Expose Cruelty at Project Chimps

Animal Rights Activists Nationwide Protest HSUS over Conditions at Project Chimps

Chimps at Humane Society Sanctuary Barely Get Outside. What Happens Next?

Entertainment

Is NYC Banning Horse-Drawn Carriages?

Bull Riding Fans Confront Animal Rights Protesters at Madison Square Garden

Anti-Trophy Hunting Activists Protest Trump Brothers and Safari Club International

Animal Rights Activists and Bull Riding Fans Face Off During Protests at Madison Square Garden



**Companion Animals**

[What Happened to Virginia Chipurnoi?](#)

---

[Updates on Campaign to Help Animals Being Warehoused at Humane Society of NY](#)

---

[NYC Lawmakers Encourage Humane Society of New York to Relocate Animals](#)

---

[Humane Society of NY Announces Renovations to Reopen to the Public After Falsely Attributing Years-long Closure to COVID](#)

---

[Animal Rights Activists Protest Humane Society of New York Veterinarians Over Animal Warehousing](#)

---

